

Subdomain ADCIRC v.51

User Guide

Technical Report CE-308-15

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March 28, 2015

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1 Introduction

ADCIRC is a computational hydrodynamic model widely used by scientists and engineers to assess the effects of hurricane storm surge on coastal areas. Extensive evaluation of storm surge often leads to the consideration of multiple flooding scenarios that require substantial computation times. Subdomain modeling is an approach to reduce the total runtime of a series of hurricane storm surge simulations on a smaller grid, a *subdomain*, extracted from the original grid. By enforcing the boundary conditions obtained from a full run, multiple simulations on a subdomain with various local changes can be performed in much less time.

2 Definitions

This section provides definitions of the terms used in this manual. The complete list of definitions of the parameters, input files, and output files used in subdomain modeling is provided in Appendices A.1 and A.2.

Full domain a large geographical area usually requiring substantial computation times. A full domain run, performed once, provides the boundary conditions for a subdomain.

Subdomain a geographical area of interest within the full domain. Multiple subdomain runs with various local changes can be performed using the boundary conditions obtained from a full domain run.

A subdomain modeling run a subdomain run or a full domain run performed to provide the boundary conditions of a subdomain run.

Subdomain modeling control file an input file required for both full domain and subdomain runs. An ADCIRC subdomain modeling run first checks whether a subdomain control file exists in the domain directory. If the file exists, subdomain modeling is activated and the parameters of subdomain modeling are read from the input files. If the file does not exist, ADCIRC performs the simulation as usual.

Shape file a file specifying the location and size of a subdomain grid within the original full domain grid.

Subdomain modeling input files the collection of files used to configure both full domain and subdomain runs. For a subdomain run, input files consist of a shape file, a control file and a boundary conditions file. For a full domain run, the only input file is a subdomain modeling control file.

3 Python Scripts

Subdomain modeling Python scripts (`gensub.py`, `genfull.py`, `genbcs.py`) allow users to extract the information from full domain input files and output files, and generate subdomain input files including a nodal attributes file, grid and boundary information file, subdomain control file, and boundary conditions file. Users provide only the parameters that configure the subdomain modeling approach and the locations of the subdomain and full domain directories.

3.1 gensub.py

`gensub.py` is used to create subdomain input files. This script reads the subdomain shape file and full domain input files, and creates the following input files in the subdomain directory:

- subdomain control file: `[subdomain dir]/fort.015`
- subdomain nodal attributes file: `[subdomain dir]/fort.13`
- subdomain grid information file: `[subdomain dir]/fort.14`
- subdomain mapping files: `[subdomain dir]/py.14*`

3.2 genfull.py

`genfull.py` is used to create the full domain control file. This script reads in the subdomain grid information file and mapping files, and creates the control file in full domain directory:

- full domain control file: `[fulldomain dir]/fort.015`

3.3 genbcs.py

`genbcs.py` is used to generate the boundary conditions file for a subdomain grid. This script reads in full domain output files, and creates the boundary conditions file in the subdomain directory:

- subdomain boundary conditions file: `[subdomain dir]/fort.019`

4 Overview of the Approach

The construction of a subdomain model in ADCIRC consists of four main steps. First, subdomain grid input files and control files are generated. Second, a full domain ADCIRC run is performed. Third, subdomain boundary conditions file is generated using full domain output files. Finally, subdomain ADCIRC run is performed. Figure 1 summarizes the main steps of the subdomain modeling approach, and Table 1 lists the required input files and generated output files for each of the Python scripts. The following section describes each of these steps in detail, including the usage of Python scripts.

5 Detailed Instructions

5.1 Generate Subdomain

First, create an empty subdomain directory. The Python script `gensub.py` requires a shape file to extract the subdomain grid from a full domain grid. Create the shape file using a text editor. A shape file contains the coordinates and the size of a subdomain. Two types of subdomain can be extracted from a full domain: circular and elliptical. For a circular

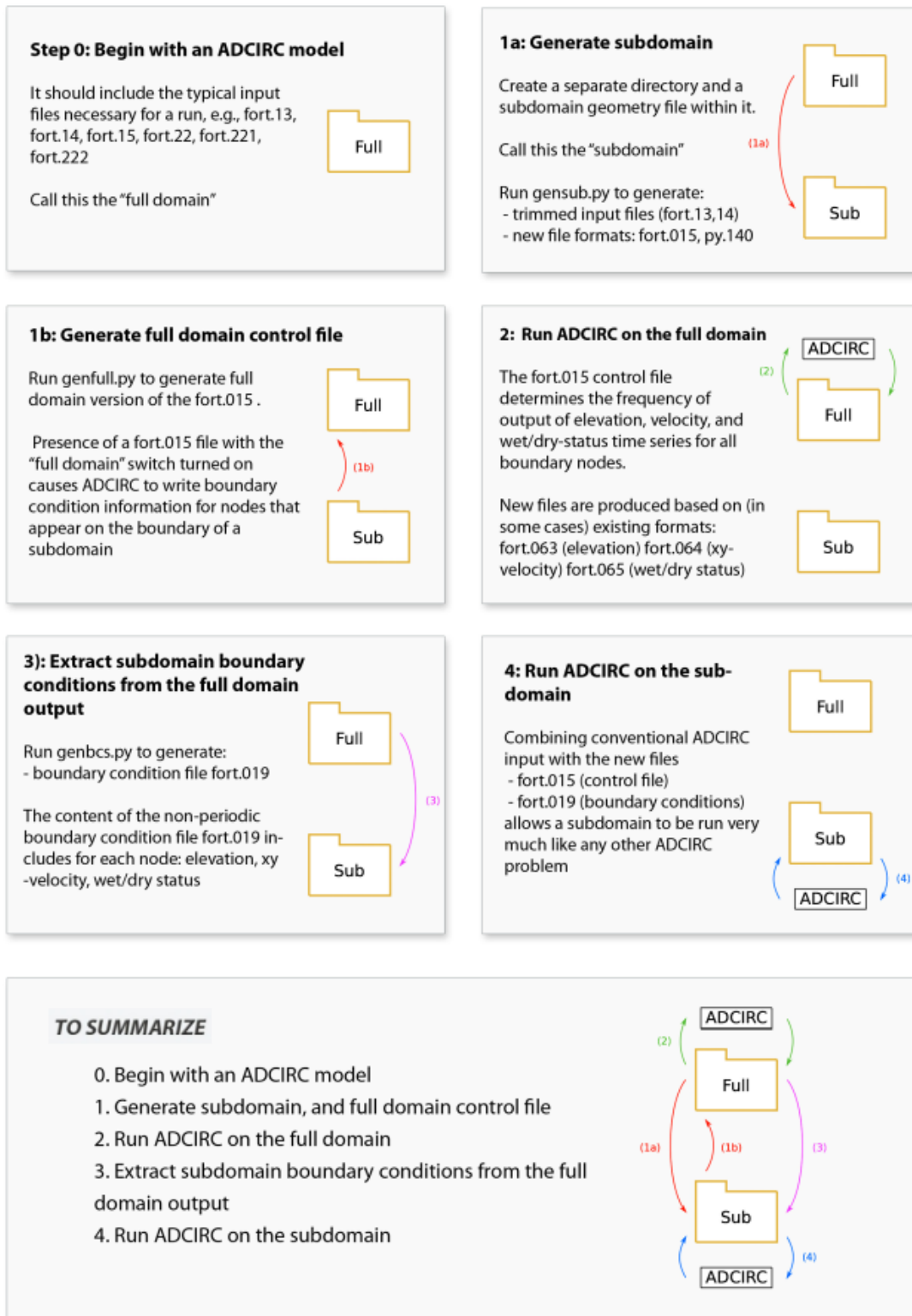


Figure 1: Summary of the work flow for subdomain modeling

Table 1: Work Flow of Subdomain Modeling Approach

	Grid	Description
1a	subdomain	Generate Subdomain <i>Python script:</i> gensub.py <i>requires:</i> [fulldomain]/fort.{13,14} [subdomain]/shape.*14 <i>generates:</i> [subdomain]/fort.{015,13,14} [subdomain]/py.14*
1b	fulldomain	Generate Full Domain Control File <i>Python script:</i> genfull.py <i>requires:</i> [subdomain]/{fort.14, py.14*} <i>generates:</i> [fulldomain]/{fort.015}
2	fulldomain	Run ADCIRC on the full domain <i>Python script:</i> - <i>requires:</i> [fulldomain]/fort.{015,13,14...} <i>generates:</i> [fulldomain]/fort.065
3	fulldomain	Extract Subdomain Boundary Conditions <i>Python script:</i> genbcs.py <i>requires:</i> [fulldomain]/fort.065 <i>generates:</i> [subdomain]/fort.019
4	subdomain	Run ADCIRC on the subdomain <i>Python script:</i> - <i>requires:</i> [fulldomain]/fort.{015,019,13,14...}

subdomain, name the shape file “**shape.c14**”, and for an elliptical subdomain, name the shape file “**shape.e14**”.

The format of a shape file for a circular subdomain (**shape.c14**) consists of two lines: the coordinates of the center of the subdomain and the radius.

shape.c14

x y r

The format of a shape file for an elliptical subdomain (**shape.e14**) consists of three lines: the coordinates of the first focal point, the coordinates of the second focal point, and the width of the ellipse.

shape.e14

x_1 y_1 x_2 y_2 w

Once the shape file is saved in the subdomain directory, use the Python script **gensub.py** to create subdomain input files: **fort.015**, **fort.14**. If the full domain has a nodal attributes file (**fort.13**); the script can also generate a **fort.13** file for the subdomain. The usage of **gensub.py** is as follows:¹

- To generate both **fort.14** and **fort.13** files:

```
$ python gensub.py [full fort.14] [shape flag] [new fort.14]
                    [full fort.13] [new fort.13]
```

- To generate just a **fort.14** file:

```
$ python gensub.py [full fort.14] [shape flag] [new fort.14]
```

Generate fort.15 file

Note: With the merging of subdomain modeling branch into the ADCIRC trunk, the namelist **subdomainModeling** is introduced to ADCIRC. Previously, subdomain modeling was activated if **fort.015** existed in the working directory. In addition to this, ADCIRC now requires **subdomainModeling** namelist to be included in both full domain and subdomain **fort.15** files. This is done by adding the following line to the end of **fort.15** file:

```
&subdomainModeling subdomainOn=T /
```

The subdomain model parameter and periodic boundary condition file (**fort.15**) should be generated by the user. Copy the full domain **fort.15** file to the subdomain directory. Modify the copied **fort.15** file to ensure that the file is compatible with the subdomain run. Required changes to a subdomain **fort.15** include:

¹The shape flag is 0 for elliptical subdomains and 1 for circular subdomains.

- If the boundary conditions are not recorded at every timestep, slightly reduce **RNDAY** (e.g., by 0.5%) to ensure that the boundary conditions file obtained from the full domain output files contains enough data to force the boundaries of the subdomain throughout the simulation.
- Set **NBFR** (total number of forcing frequencies) to 0.
- Remove lines that define periodic forcing frequencies. Since the boundaries of the subdomain are forced using a boundary conditions file, periodic forcing is not necessary.
- Remove coordinates of any recording stations that are outside of the subdomain grid.
- Update the number of recording stations.

Generate Meteorological Files

If the full domain has any meteorological forcing files (e.g., **fort.22**, **fort.221**, **fort.222**, and so on) that define wind velocity and atmospheric pressure on rectangular (lat/lon) grid(s), symbolically link these files in the subdomain directory. Meteorological files that define wind velocity and atmospheric pressure at each grid node are required to be scaled by the user.

Generate full domain control file

The only subdomain modeling input file for a full domain run is the control file, **fort.015**.² The Python script **genfull.py** is used to create the control file of a full domain run. This script asks the user to input subdomain modeling parameter **NSPOOLGS** and directories³ of the full domain and subdomain runs.

The subdomain modeling approach in ADCIRC introduces a new output file based on existing formats: **fort.065**. The sampling rate and reported nodes in this file is determined by the user. The Python script **genfull.py** allows users to specify the boundary nodes of the subdomains as the output nodes. Having an additional set of output files allows ADCIRC to report the data of the boundary nodes of a subdomain at a greater frequency while using less disk space. There are two options for creating a **fort.015** file using **genfull.py**:

1. Assign the boundary nodes of previously created subdomains as output nodes. This option requires much less disk space, but it only provides the output data for subdomain grids generated prior to the full domain run. Boundary node numbers of subdomains are automatically mapped to full domain node numbers and recorded in the **fort.015** file in the full domain directory. Any number of subdomains may be specified.
2. Assign all the full domain nodes as output nodes. This option may lead to excessively large output files, especially when the recording frequency is high. However, the

²If the control file does not exist in the full domain directory, the ADCIRC run is performed as usual, i.e., additional output files used to extract the boundary conditions of a subdomain will not be generated.

³Directory paths passed to Python scripts as arguments must end with a forward slash (/).

availability of data for each node means that subdomains can later be generated anywhere in the full domain, providing greater flexibility.

The script first asks user to type in the parameter `NSPOOLGS`, the number of timesteps at which information is written to the new output file `fort.065`. Then, user is asked if predefined subdomain(s) will be provided. By entering “n”, users can configure full domain run to record boundary conditions for every node in the full domain grid. If user types in “y”, the script then asks for the subdomain directories in succession. Once the user enters all the directories, the generation of full domain control file can be finalized by entering “done”.

Usage:

```
$ python genfull.py [FullDomain Path]
```

Note: Ensure that the full domain run also includes the namelist `subdomainModeling` at the end of its `fort.15` file:

```
&subdomainModeling subdomainOn=T /
```

5.2 Run ADCIRC on Full Domain

Perform the full domain ADCIRC run to obtain the new set of output files which are used to produce the boundary conditions of the subdomain. Note that the subdomain modeling approach in ADCIRC is activated only if the control file `fort.015` exists in the working directory. Both serial and parallel ADCIRC can be used to perform a full domain run.

5.3 Extract Subdomain Boundary Conditions

The boundary conditions file of a subdomain is generated using `genbcs.py`. This script reads the `fort.065` file of the full domain, and produces a boundary conditions file, `fort.019`, containing time varying elevations, velocities, and wet/dry flags of boundary nodes, inside the subdomain directory. The sampling rate of this file, called `sbtiminc`, is determined by the user.⁴ The type of the full domain run (serial or parallel) must be specified by the user.

Usage:

```
$ python genfull.py [FullDomain Path] [Subdomain Path] [NOUTGS] [sbtiminc]
```

Depending on the size of the grid and the sampling rate, producing the boundary conditions using `genbcs.py` may take some time.

5.4 Run ADCIRC on Subdomain

The final step of subdomain modeling approach is to run ADCIRC on the subdomain. Multiple ADCIRC runs with various local changes to the subdomain model can be performed using the same boundary conditions file, so long as changes in the hydrodynamics do not propagate out to the subdomain boundaries.

⁴`sbtiminc` must be a multiple of `NSPOOLGS`, the number of time steps at which information is written to full domain output files.

6 Example Usage on the Quarter Annular Test Case

In this section, the subdomain modeling approach is applied to the quarter annular test case, a simple example problem available from the ADCIRC Development Group. The quarter annular grid shown in Figure 2 consists of 63 nodes and 96 triangular elements. The outside arc is an open ocean boundary subject to tidal forces, and the remaining sides are closed land boundaries.

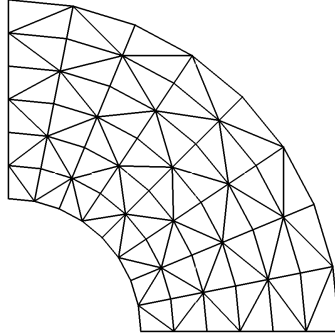


Figure 2: Quarter Annular Test Grid

Using subdomain modeling Python scripts, an elliptical subdomain grid consisting of 16 nodes and 18 elements is extracted from the original quarter annular grid, as shown in Figure 3. Boundary conditions are obtained from the original full run, and are then used for the elliptical subdomain. The steps of the approach are described below.

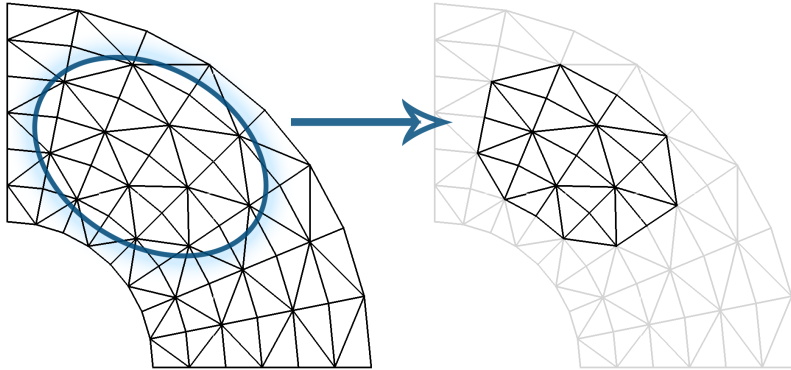


Figure 3: Elliptical Subdomain Grid

Generate Subdomain:

1. Create an empty subdomain directory.
2. Create the shape file using a text editor, and save it in the subdomain directory.

shape.e14

40824.6 98559.5
98559.5 40824.6
60000

3. Move to the subdomain directory, and run `gensub.py` to generate the subdomain input files `fort.14` and `fort.015`.⁵ Note that the directory path of a `fort.13` file is not specified, since this example does not require a nodal attributes file.

```
$ python [script dir]/gensub.py [full.dir]/fort.14 0 fort.14
```

4. Add the following line to the end of full domain `fort.15` file:

```
&subdomainModeling subdomainOn=T /
```

5. Copy the full domain `fort.15` file to the subdomain directory, and modify it as follows⁶:

- Set `NBFR` to 0.
- Remove the lines that are related to periodic forcing frequencies.⁷
- Remove the coordinates of elevation and velocity recording stations.
- Set number of elevation and velocity recording stations to 0.

Note that this example does not require any meteorological file.

6. Move to the full domain directory and run `genfull.py` to generate the full domain control file `fort.015`. Although file sizes are of no concern in this small example, only the boundary nodes of the subdomain are written to the full domain `fort.015` file to illustrate the approach. Note that directory paths passed to Python scripts as arguments must end with a forward slash (/) (e.g., `/home/[user]/qa-subdomain/`).

```
$ python [script dir]/genfull.py ./
```

```
Enter the parameter 'NSPOOLGS' (the freq. of forcing in no. of timesteps):
1
Reading fort.14 at ./
Specify predetermined subdomains? (y or n)
y
Enter the directory of the subdomain: (Type 'done' to end)
```

⁵Additionally, auxiliary mapping files `py.140` and `py.141` will be created.

⁶The resulting subdomain `fort.15` file is shown in Appendix A.4.

⁷In this example, 12 lines after the line with `NBFR`.

```

../qa-sub/
Reading boundary information of ../qa-sub/
Reading fort.14 at ../qa-sub/
Reading py.140 at ../qa-sub/
Subdomain info at ../qa-sub/ is added to the full domain control file.
Enter the directory of the subdomain: (Type 'done' to end)
done
fort.015 file for the full run is ready.

```

The script asks user to type in the parameter `NSPOOLGS`. For this example problem, type “1” and press **enter**. By setting `NSPOOLGS` to 1, it is ensured that the boundary information for the subdomain run will be recorded at every timestep. The script then asks user if predefined subdomain(s) will be provided. Since a subdomain is created prior to ADCIRC full domain run, type in “y”, and press **enter**. The script then asks users to type in the subdomain directories. Enter the directory to the subdomain grid. Enter “done” to finalize the generation of full domain control file.

Run ADCIRC on Full Domain:

Perform the full domain ADCIRC run, either in serial or in parallel.

Extract Subdomain Boundary Conditions:

1. Move to the subdomain directory.
2. Generate the `fort.019` boundary conditions file for the subdomain run using `genbcs.py`.

```
$ python [script dir]/genbcs.py [full dir] [sub dir] 1 1
```

Enter the type of the full run (p for parallel, s for serial):

```

s
Reading fort.14 at ../qa/
Reading fort.14 at ./
Reading py.140 at ./

```

The script asks users if the full domain run was performed using serial ADCIRC or parallel ADCIRC. Type in `s` or `p` accordingly.

Run ADCIRC on Subdomain:

Perform the subdomain ADCIRC run, either in serial or in parallel.

Maximum elevation difference

Maximum elevations files of both runs are compared, and it is observed that the largest difference between the full domain run and the enforced subdomain run at a node is 2×10^{-7} meters.

A Appendix

A.1 Subdomain Modeling Parameters

NOUTGS: Subdomain modeling flag for a full domain run. By setting this parameter to 1 in the full domain control file, the required subdomain boundary conditions for Type-1 are recorded, and by setting this parameter to 2, the required subdomain boundary conditions for Type-2 are recorded. Note: Type-2 runs are for test purposes only.

NSPOOLGS: The number of timesteps at which information is written to the new set of output files; fort.06*.

enforceBN: Subdomain modeling flag for a subdomain run. Type-1 is activated by setting this parameter to 1 in the subdomain control file, and Type-2 is activated by setting this parameter to 2. Note that the required boundary conditions file(s) need to exist in the subdomain directory.

ncbnr: The number of outer boundary nodes of Type-1 subdomain grids to be recorded during a full run.

cbnr: Array of nodes containing the outer boundary nodes of Type-1 subdomain grids to be recorded during a full run.

ncbn: The number of outer boundary nodes of a Type-1 subdomain.

eta2(n): Forced elevation at node n.

etas(n): Forced elevation change at node n.

uu2(n): Forced x velocity at node n.

vv2(n): Forced y velocity at node n.

nodecode(n): Forced wet/dry flag at node n.

A.2 Subdomain Modeling File Formats

A.2.1 fort.015 - Model control parameters

NOUTGS

NSPOOLGS

enforceBN

ncbnr

for cnode in cbnr:

cnode

A.2.2 fort.019 - Subdomain boundary conditions file (enforceBN=1)

```
header
nspoolgs, ncbnr, #timesteps
for n in cbnr:
    n
for it in #timesteps:
    it
    for n in cbn:
        n, eta2(n), uu2(n)
        vv2(n), nodecode(n)
```

A.2.3 fort.065 - Full domain output file (noutgs=1)

```
header
nspoolgs, ncbnr, #timesteps
for it in #timesteps:
    it
    for n in cbnr:
        n, eta2(n), uu2(n)
        vv2(n), nodecode(n)
```

A.3 Modified fort.15 file for the elliptical QATC subdomain

```
QUARTER ANNULAR TEST EXAMPLE 1
ADCIRC V41.03
0 ! NFOVER
0 ! NABOUT
1 ! NSCREEN
0 ! IHOT
1 ! ICS
0 ! IM
1 ! NOLIBF
1 ! NOLIFA
1 ! NOLICA
1 ! NOLICAT
0 ! NWP
0 ! NCOR
0 ! NTIP
0 ! NWS
1 ! NRAMP
9.81 ! G
0.005 ! TAUO
174.656 ! DT
0.00 ! STATIM
0.00 ! REFTIM
5 ! RNDAY
```

2.0	! DRAMP
0.35 0.30 0.35	! TIME WEIGHTING FACTORS FOR THE GWCE EQUATION
1.0	! HO
0.0 0.0	! SLAMO,SFEAO
0.0025	! FFACTOR
0.0	! ESL
0.0	! CORI
0	! NTIF
0	! NBFR
110.0	! ANGINN
1 0.0 5.0 3	! NOUTE,TOUTSE,TOUTFE,NSPOOLE
0	! TOTAL NUMBER OF ELEVATION RECORDING STATIONS
1 0.0 5.0 3	! NOUTV,TOUTSV,TOUTFV,NSPOOLV
0	! TOTAL NUMBER OF VELOCITY RECORDING STATIONS
1 0.0 5.0 1	! NOUTGE,TOUTSGE,TOUTFGE,NSPOOLGE
1 0.0 5.0 1	! NOUTGV,TOUTSGV,TOUTFGV,NSPOOLGV
1	! NHARFR
M2	! HAFNAM(I)
0.0001405257 1.0 0.0	! HAFREQ(I=1),HAFF(I=1),HAFACE(I=1)
4.00 5.00 1 0.0	! THAS,THAF,NHAINC,FMV
1 1 1 1	! NHASE,NHASV,NHAGE,NHAGV
1 512	! NHSTAR,NHSINC
1 0 1.E-5 25	! ITITER, ISLDIA, CONVCR, ITMAX

B Acknowledgments

This material is based upon work supported by the Coastal Hazards Center of Excellence, a US Department of Homeland Security Science and Technology Center of Excellence under Award Number: 2008-ST-061-ND 0001, and a Department of Homeland Security HS-STEM Career Development Grant.

The views and conclusions contained in this document are those of the authors and should not be interpreted as necessarily representing the official policies, either expressed or implied, of the US Department of Homeland Security.

The authors wish to thank Dr. Rick Luettich and Dr. Brian Blanton for their assistance with ADCIRC and for providing base grids and input files.

C List of Publications and Talks

Altuntas, A. (2012). “Downscaling storm surge models for engineering applications.” M.S. Thesis, NC State University, Raleigh, NC, July.

[<http://www.lib.ncsu.edu/resolver/1840.16/8035>]

Baugh, J. W. (2012). “Subdomain modeling.” 2012 ADCIRC Workshop, NOAA in Silver Spring, MD, April 23–24.

Baugh, J. W., Rutledge, J., Altuntas, A., and Dyer, T. (2012). “Downscaling storm surge models for engineering applications.” Tenth International Conference on Hydroscience & Engineering (ICHE), Orlando, FL, November 4–7.

Baugh, J. W., and Simon, J. S. (2011). “Localized storm surge modeling for engineering analysis and design.” ECM 12: Twelfth International Conference on Estuarine and Coastal Modeling, St. Augustine, FL, November 7–9.

Simon, J. S. (2011). “A computational approach for local storm surge modeling.” M.S. Thesis, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC, June.

[<http://www.lib.ncsu.edu/resolver/1840.16/7179>]

Simon, J. S., and Baugh, J. W. (2011). “Localized modeling of storm surge effects on civil infrastructure using nested meshes.” WRRI Annual Conference, Raleigh, NC, March 22–23.